

Phase - 1 (SmartShop CRM)

Problem Statement

A retail chain is struggling to effectively manage customer engagement across **walk-in stores (offline)** and **online platforms (e-commerce)**. At present, customer purchases are stored in separate systems, and loyalty program points are tracked manually through spreadsheets or paper-based records. This leads to frequent errors, customer dissatisfaction, and inconsistent engagement.

Additionally, inventory shortages are not tracked in real-time, causing product mismatches between online orders and in-store availability. Managers are unable to view live reports on sales, stock, or loyalty performance, limiting their ability to make quick business decisions. Sales representatives also lack access to insights about high-value customers, which restricts their ability to provide personalized offers and services.

This fragmented process results in **inefficient operations, reduced customer satisfaction, and missed opportunities for sales growth**.

The proposed solution is to build a Salesforce-based CRM system—**RetailHub CRM**—to centralize customer data, automate loyalty tracking, provide real-time inventory visibility, and deliver actionable insights through reports and dashboards.

Phase 1.1: Requirement Gathering

The initial step of the project was to analyze the **core challenges and operational gaps** faced by the retail chain. A detailed assessment was conducted to identify the pain points and areas requiring immediate improvement.

Key Problems Identified

1. Customer Data Fragmentation

- Purchases from offline stores and the online website were stored in separate systems.
- Lack of a single customer view made tracking purchase history and engagement inconsistent.

2. Manual Loyalty Program Tracking

- Loyalty points were recorded manually in Excel or paper logs.
- Errors in calculations reduced customer trust and satisfaction.

3. Inventory Inefficiency

- Stock levels were not updated in real time.
- This caused frequent product shortages and mismatches between online/offline sales.

4. Lack of Customer Insights

- Sales representatives were unaware of top or loyal customers.
- Missed opportunities for personalized engagement and targeted offers.

5. Reporting Limitations

- Managers did not have access to real-time performance reports.
- Business decisions were delayed due to reliance on outdated data.

Phase 1.2: Stakeholder Analysis

To ensure RetailHub CRM aligns with business needs, the key stakeholders were identified. Each group's role and requirements were studied to design a system that caters to their specific needs.

Main Stakeholders Identified

1. Store Managers

- **Need:** Clear visibility of store performance and inventory.
- **Requirement:** Real-time dashboards covering sales, inventory, and loyalty status.

2. Sales Representatives (Offline & Online)

- **Need:** Access to accurate customer data.

- **Requirement:** Comprehensive profiles with purchase history and loyalty status to deliver personalized offers.

3. Customers

- **Need:** Smooth shopping experience with transparent loyalty tracking.
- **Requirement:** Easy visibility of loyalty points, personalized promotions, and accurate product availability across channels.

4. Business Owners / Management

- **Need:** Strategic insights to drive growth.
- **Requirement:** Summary-level analytics on sales growth, customer retention, and operational efficiency.

5. Admins

- **Need:** Ensure smooth functioning of CRM.
- **Requirement:** Configure automations, manage data, and maintain system reliability.

Phase 1.3: Business Process Mapping

The project compared the **current manual processes (As-Is)** with the **future Salesforce-enabled processes (To-Be)** to highlight efficiency improvements.

Current (As-Is) Manual Process

1. Purchase Recording

- Purchases logged separately in POS or Excel.
- No unified record of customer history.

2. Loyalty Points Tracking

- Points added manually by staff.
- Errors common → reduced customer trust.

3. Inventory & Stock Updates

- Inventory not updated in real-time.
- Shortages often identified too late.

4. Reporting

- Reports prepared monthly or quarterly.
- No real-time visibility for managers.

Proposed (To-Be) Salesforce-Enabled Process

1. Centralized Purchase Records

- All online and offline purchases stored in Salesforce.
- Provides a 360° customer view.

2. Automated Loyalty Management

- Points auto-calculated and redeemed using automation.
- Reduces manual errors, improves customer satisfaction.

3. Real-Time Inventory Updates

- Stock levels updated instantly after every purchase.
- Low-stock alerts sent automatically to managers.

4. Instant Reports & Dashboards

- Live dashboards available to managers.
- Helps in faster, data-driven decision making.

Flow Diagram for Smartshop CRM

